BuildLinka

Features by profile and how the app works

Covers the four profiles: Vendor, Worker, Engineer and Buyer. Written for review of the app as it is in the code today (Expo SDK 56, version 1.0.0, 30 September 2026).

Important: The app is currently a **working design prototype**. Every screen can be opened and used, but all names, products, orders, earnings and projects are sample data built into the app. Nothing is sent to a server, nothing is saved after the app closes, and no real money moves. Section 7 lists exactly what is real and what is demo.

1. How the app works (the journey)

1. **Welcome slides.** On first open the user sees swipeable intro slides. They can tap *Skip* or *Get Started*.
2. **"Who are you?"** The user chooses one of four profiles: Vendor, Worker, Engineer or Buyer, then taps *Continue*. There is also a link to go straight to the main app without choosing.
3. **Profile dashboard.** Each profile opens its own dashboard with its own tools (described in sections 2 to 5).
4. **Main app (5 tabs).** Shared by everyone: **Home**, **Materials**, **Cart**, **Workers** and **Profile**. From here anyone can browse materials, view products, add to cart, find workers and open settings.

Shared tabs at a glance

Tab	What the user can do
Home	Location bar, notifications bell, greeting, search, promo card, 12 material categories, featured banners, best deals, popular vendors, workers near you, pull to refresh.
Materials	Search, category chips, sort (popular, price low/high, rating), filters, grid or list view.
Cart	Items added from any product page, quantities, order summary, go to checkout.
Workers	Search, trade chips (mason, electrician, etc.), "Available only" and "Top rated" filters, grid or list.
Profile	User card and stats, referral card, recent activity, orders, listings, reviews, settings, logout.

Material categories: Cement, Blocks, Steel & Iron, Roofing, Tiles, Paint, Plumbing, Electrical, Timber, Glass, Equipment, and more. Each category has its own product list, and each product has a detail page with photos, vendor, rating, price, delivery, quantity selector, reviews, shipping info and "You may also like".

2. Vendor profile

Who: shops and suppliers who sell building materials. **Goal:** list products, manage stock and track sales.

Vendor dashboard

- Store header with store name and an **Open / Closed** switch for the shop.
- Four key numbers: **Total sales**, **Orders**, **Profile views**, **Rating**.
- **Critical stock alerts** for products running low, each with a *Restock* button.
- **Sales trend** chart for the last 6 months with the total.
- **Recent orders** with status: Pending, Shipped, Delivered.
- Quick actions: **Add listing**, **Inventory**, **Analytics**, **Settings**. Notifications bell with unread count.

Vendor tools

Screen	Features
Add Listing	Step-by-step form: product photos (camera or gallery, at least one required, several allowed), title, category, description and details, price (NGN) and stock quantity, final review page showing total listing value and estimated earnings.
My Listings	Tabs for Listings, Inventory and Drafts. Status labels (Active, Draft, In stock, Sold). Add to stock with quantity and cost price, shows margin and profit per product, restock, set minimum stock level, delete a listing.
My Inventory	Search all products, low stock list, total stock and total stock value, selling price and margin per item.
Sales Analytics	Sales by month and by week, best selling products, busiest hours and days, key metrics (e.g. conversion rate), customer insights: new vs repeat customers.
Orders	All orders with status filters: Pending, Confirmed, Shipped, Delivered, Cancelled.

How it works for a vendor

1. Choose *Vendor* on the "Who are you?" screen and open the dashboard.
2. Tap *Add listing*, add photos, fill details, price and stock, review and publish.
3. Buyers find the product in Home, Materials or the category pages and order it.
4. The vendor watches orders, stock alerts and analytics, and restocks when stock is low.

3. Worker profile

Who: tradespeople such as masons, electricians, plumbers, painters, tilers, carpenters. **Goal:** get hired, manage jobs and track earnings.

Worker dashboard

- Profile header with name, trade and **daily rate**.
- **Availability switch**: tells clients if the worker is free for new jobs.
- Overview numbers (jobs, rating, and similar) and a list of the worker's **skills**.
- **Earnings**: this week, this month and last month.
- **Upcoming jobs** with status: Confirmed, Pending, Completed.
- Quick actions: **Create work**, **Find jobs**, **Profile**, **Reviews**, **Team**, **Settings**.

Worker tools

Screen	Features
Create Work	Step-by-step listing of the worker's services: choose trade, choose skills (several allowed), daily rate (NGN), location, phone number, availability, optional description, review page, then submit. The message says the listing will be reviewed before clients can see it.
Find Jobs (Nearby)	List of jobs near the user (e.g. block laying, house wiring, tiling, roofing, plumbing, painting) with budget and an *Apply* button. Also shows nearby workers with a *Hire* button.
Edit Profile	Photo, full name, email, phone, location, bio, plus stats (orders, listings, days active).
My Reviews	Reviews and ratings from clients.
Team	Team members and their status: Active, Idle, On site.

How it works for a worker

1. Choose *Worker* and open the dashboard.
2. Tap *Create work* to publish trade, skills and daily rate.
3. Keep the availability switch on to show up for clients. Buyers find the worker in the Workers tab or Hire screens.
4. Use *Find jobs* to apply for nearby jobs, then track upcoming jobs and earnings on the dashboard.

4. Engineer profile

Who: registered engineers who supervise building projects. **Goal:** oversee projects, budgets, teams and technical documents.

Engineer dashboard

- Profile header with name, title (e.g. Structural Engineer), location, years of experience, projects completed, rating and **COREN licence number** badge.
- Overview metrics for the engineer's work.
- **Active projects** cards: status (On track, At risk, Delayed), budget, amount spent, deadline and progress bar.
- Quick counts: **Specs**, **Inspections**, **Site visits**.
- Quick actions: **My projects**, **Team**, **Specs**, **Settings**.

Engineer tools

Screen	Features
My Projects	All projects with total budget and total spent, each with status, deadline and progress.
Team	Engineers and workers on the team, with totals and status: Active, Idle, On site.
Specifications	Technical documents such as foundation design, concrete mix design, reinforcement schedule, structural steel specs, steel connection details, MEP specifications. Each shows status: Approved, In review, Draft.

How it works for an engineer

1. Choose *Engineer* and open the dashboard.
2. Check active projects that are at risk or delayed, and compare spending against budget.
3. Manage the team and see who is on site.
4. Open specifications to see which designs are approved, in review or still drafts.

5. Buyer profile

Who: home owners, developers and contractors. **Goal:** buy materials, hire workers and plan building projects.

Buyer dashboard

- Welcome header with notifications bell and **cart button with item count**.
- Summary numbers for the buyer's activity.
- **Shop by category** shortcuts and **Recommended for you** products.
- **Recent orders** with status: Processing, Shipped, Delivered.
- Quick actions: **Build** (plan a project), **Cart**, **Hire**, **Orders**.

Buyer tools

Screen	Features
Build Project	Project planner. Quick-start templates (3-bedroom bungalow, duplex/mansion, shop/office). Steps: project basics (name, type, size, site location, description), timeline and budget (Budget friendly, Standard, Premium, Luxury), review showing estimated budget and duration, cost breakdown (materials, labour, contingency), materials needed (cement, steel, roofing, tiles, paint, plumbing, electrical, timber...), workers needed, and payment plan. Includes an **"AI Building Assistant"** chat that fills the form.
Cart	Items, quantities, delivery cost, order summary, recommended items for the project.
Checkout	Step-by-step: delivery method (Standard, Express, Pickup station), address (address, city, state, phone), payment method (Card, Bank transfer, Paystack), order summary, *Place order*, success screen.
Hire workers	Workers marketplace: search and filter workers, then a hire request form with start date, number of days, job description and estimated total cost (daily rate x days).
Orders / History	Current orders with status, and order history filtered by All, Delivered, Cancelled, Returned, with total spent.
Saved	Saved (wishlist) products and saved locations such as home, office, site, warehouse (can use current GPS location).
Popular vendors	List of top vendors to browse.

How it works for a buyer

1. Choose *Buyer* and open the dashboard (or skip and use the main tabs).
2. Optional: use *Build* to plan a project and see the materials, workers and budget needed.
3. Browse materials, open a product, choose quantity and add to cart.
4. Checkout: choose delivery, enter address, choose payment and place the order.
5. Hire workers from the Workers tab or Hire screen, then track orders from the dashboard.

6. Other screens (all users)

Screen	Features
Notifications	List of alerts with unread count shown on every dashboard bell.
Settings	Edit profile, notifications, language, saved locations, privacy & security, help center, about. Also a hidden admin entry protected by a 4-digit PIN.
Admin Panel	Platform overview (users, vendors, workers, engineers, buyers, products, orders, revenue), user lists, compose push notification to an audience, featured banners, reports, export, sync data, platform settings, lock panel.
Delivery Dashboard	Logistics screen with active, completed and delayed deliveries and alerts. (Built, but no button in the app opens it yet.)
Help Center / Privacy	Help topics and privacy & security options.

7. What is real and what is demo today

Area	Status today
Screens, navigation, animations	**Working**. All screens open and move correctly.
Camera, photo gallery, GPS location	**Working**. Uses real phone permissions.
Cart, saved items, notifications	**Works while the app is open**. Lost when the app is closed.
Products, vendors, workers, orders, projects, earnings	**Sample data** written in the app code.
Login / accounts	**Not built**. No sign up, no login, no user accounts.
Chosen profile (role)	**Not saved**. The app asks again every time it starts.
Payments (Card, Transfer, Paystack)	**Demo only**. Placing an order just clears the cart.
AI Building Assistant	**Scripted replies**. Not connected to a real AI.
Listings, hire requests, work listings	**Demo only**. Success message shows, nothing is sent.

8. Problems found in this review

#	Problem	Where
1	Worker dashboard "View all" (upcoming jobs) opens a screen that does not exist (/my-jobs).	worker-dashboard.tsx, line 208
2	Delivery dashboard is built but no button in the app opens it.	delivery-dashboard.tsx
3	On the Nearby screen the *Hire* and *Apply* buttons do nothing when pressed.	nearby.tsx, lines 211 and 275
4	After leaving a dashboard there is no way back to it from the main tabs or profile.	profile tab
5	Admin PIN is fixed as "1234" inside the app. Anyone who knows it can open the admin panel.	settings.tsx, line 20
6	Hermes JS engine in this Expo version has a known memory problem. Fixed in Expo SDK 57.	package.json

Suggestions for fixing these and making the app ready for real users are in the second document, **"BuildLinka - Suggestions for Real-World Launch"**.